

MID-TERM EVALUATION REPORT

What follows is a report on the mid-term evaluation of the Monitoring and Evaluation Certification Programme, March–May 2026 cohort.

Purpose

This report provide an assesment of the first four modules of the course, carried out to review progress, identify challenges, and inform adjustments in light of the programme’s effectiveness and relevance (OECD, 2021).

Scope

The first four modules are the programme’s introductory modules. Their content is structured around (1) Results-Based Management (RBM) and project design (2) the Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system; (3) data collection, monitoring plan, risks and assumptions, and (4) data analysis and report writing.

The programme’s target audience includes monitoring and evaluation specialists, project coordinators, programme managers, independent evaluators, donor staff and non-governmental organization staff involved in monitoring and evaluation.

Data collection

Data for this mid-term evaluation were collected during the week of the delivery of Module 5, through an online module administered via the eCampus platform. The survey included three open-ended questions on: (1) what participants have appreciated about the course, (2) what participants have not appreciated; and (3) suggestions for improvement. In addition, a closed-ended question assessed overall satisfaction with the course. Responses to the open-ended questions were analysed using thematic analysis with an inductive coding approach. No additional data were collected.

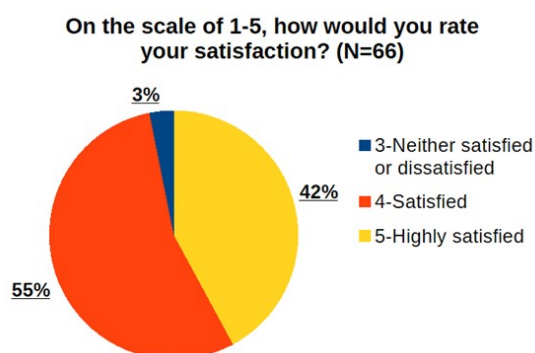
Presentation of findings¹

A total of 66 participants responded

Regarding global satisfaction with the course, the responses show no negative evaluations. A small minority of neutral responses (n = 3; 3%) is observed, while the majority fall within the categories “satisfied” (n = 39; 55%) and “very satisfied” (n = 24; 42%), indicating a generally high level of participant satisfaction.

The majority of participants appreciate aspects related to the course structure, the opportunity to develop their own skills and apply them to real projects, the resources provided, and the possibility of receiving support through feedback, interaction, and exchange. About the structure, what is more appreciated are the modular structure of the course (n = 45) and its incremental approach (n = 12), the practical nature of the assignments (n = 35), and the possibility to apply knowledge to real cases and to the development of their own projects (n = 11). Moreover, some of them appreciate the rigor and depth of the topics covered (n = 9) and have developed an increased confidence for the future development of their own M&E systems (n = 14). Participants highlight the value of peer exchange through online sessions (n = 13) and the opportunity to receive feedback from coaches is also highly appreciated (n = 17).

Overall, the data show the effectiveness of the programme in conveying a meaningful learning experience to participants and an effective trasfer and application of knowledge.



¹ Please refer to the Annex for the results

However, the same areas identified above present room for improvement, participants believe that the time required every week is greater than expected (n = 25), and would prefer more scheduling options (n = 4). Some participants feel that webinars are not sufficiently focused on the subsequent assignments (n = 5). Moreover, some say that the course lacks alignment with their work context (n = 4) and examples of real-world applications (n = 4). Additional feedback concerns a lack of mandatory opportunities of interaction among participants (n = 8) to exchange ideas. Finally some participants report issues of clarity regarding the written assignments and the expected outputs (n = 6).

Overall, these data suggest that the relevance of the course to participants could be improved.

Among the most frequent specific recommendations, participants highlight the need to include broader illustrations of how course concepts can be applied to real-world cases (n = 13), to revise the internal structure of the modules (n = 3), to reduce the weekly workload (n = 8), and to improve the clarity of weekly assignment tasks (n = 8). With regard to participation and interactivity, some participants suggest introducing group activities (n = 9) and weekly participant meetings (n = 9), as well as providing more structure to breakout room sessions (n = 4). Additional suggestions include correcting typos (n = 7), adding end-of-module summaries (n = 4), and incorporating facilitation tools to support learning processes (n=4).

What emerges from the data is that the most frequent recommendations concern the application of what is covered in the course, both in relation to assignments and the provision of real-world examples. Through these measures, the relevance of the course could be increased.

Conclusions and recommendations

Taken together, the analyses suggest an overall positive evaluation of the programme, and elements that could add up to its effectiveness and relevance. Its greatest strengths lie in offering an incremental, theoretically robust learning pathway enriched by extensive supplementary materials, in which participants are encouraged to appropriate knowledge and apply it to real cases through assignments. The programme also offers a time structure that requires focus and personal commitment, further strengthened by the opportunity to receive feedback from sector experts. This enables participants to develop a sense of efficacy in applying what they have learned and to transfer it successfully to their current professional role.

At the same time, the findings indicate that participants perceive the weekly workload and module planning negatively, and as insufficiently clear regarding completion expectations. Moreover, participants report insufficient attention to the real-world application of course content, particularly through examples of complete M&E systems applied to actual cases, which limits the programme's relevance. Participants' recommendations align closely with these observations. It is therefore recommended that greater attention be given to aligning course content with real-world cases by incorporating more contextualised examples drawn from actual projects, as well as illustrations of the application of complete M&E systems. This would strengthen participants' ability to transfer acquired knowledge to their own professional contexts. The effectiveness of content delivery could also benefit from extending the course pace beyond the current weekly schedule, while simultaneously increasing the structure of breakout rooms and planning dedicated opportunities for peer exchange and knowledge-sharing based on participants' real field experiences. Additional improvements to the course's relevance and effectiveness may also be achieved through the inclusion of group activities within these sessions.

It is important to keep in mind that the evaluator is also a beneficiary of the programme. This creates a risk of bias and may affect objectivity and independence.